Who Benefits from Remote Schooling? Self-Selection and Match Effects*

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Abstract

This paper studies the distributional effects of remote learning by combining preference data from a conjoint survey with administrative records. Our analysis uses a selection-on-observables framework that relies on choice experiments to characterize selection, allowing us to recover average and heterogeneous effects. We validate the approach using variation from school choice lotteries. On average, remote learning reduced test scores, but students with the highest estimated demand experienced gains. Bullying concerns strongly predict demand, and remote learning broadly improved bullying outcomes. For most enrollees, these improvements are a compensating differential for learning losses.

JEL Classification: I21, I24.
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